

Company: Barclays

Job Profile: Technology Developer Graduate

Offer Type: Placement Only

Internship Stipend: N/A

CTC: 13.5 LPA

Location: Pune

Process Date:

OA round : 26th July 2025

PPT + Interviews - 29th July 2025

Resume:  resume_barclays-1.pdf

Placement Process:

1. **OA Round** [135 candidates appeared, 37 shortlisted]

Eligibility criteria required a CGPA of 7+. There was also some kind of shortlisting based on resumes. The OA round comprised of 3 sections:

Section 1: MCQs mainly covering concepts of OOPs, SQL queries, output based questions based on Java/C++. This was randomized, some people got java based output questions, while others got C++. Most of the questions were OOPs/output related, with a couple of SQL questions.

Section 2: DSA question : [String Generation OA question](#). This question had been repeated by Barclays in previous couple of years, so it was advantageous for students who had practiced the PYQ. Furthermore, test cases were weak, so it was possible to pass all test cases with some simple logic, without a very complex algorithm.

Section 3: SQL query, easy level. Was solvable with some where clauses. Some students got an SQL query that involved extracting the month from a date along with basic logic.

#Tip1: Ensure that you are really clear conceptually with OOPs, as different MCQs had differing weightages attached to them. MCQs turned out to be the deciding factor as most students could solve the DSA question and SQL query fully.

#Tip2: Apart from SQL50 on LeetCode, ensure to familiarize yourself with basic String and Date functions and their syntax in SQL.

2. **Tech Round** [35 candidates appeared, 19 Shortlisted]

We weren't told at what time exactly our individual interviews would be, instead every person was being called and sent to their respective panel. This was a long and drawn out process, and intern and grad interviews were ongoing at the same time. The interviews started at 10am after the PPT, and my interview was finally conducted at 3:30pm. It went on for around 30 mins.

The interviewer started off by testing me on my knowledge of Java & OOPs.

Q. What is inheritance?

-> (standard explanation with info about what is inherited from the base class.)

Q. In the eg below, how can i call x function in class A in the following cases:

- Inside class B
- By creating an object of B

```
Class A{
    void x() {
        System.out.println("A");
    }
}
Class B extends A{
    void x() {
        System.err.println("B");
    }
}
```

-> Case 1: Using the super keyword. I then clarified what the super keyword is used for - all parent constructors, variables and functions, except for those which are private and static.

Case 2: Here, I first clarified with the interviewer what the reference type of the object was. This allowed him to further interrogate me about reference type, and what would happen in both cases, where reference type was of A and B. He also asked me if reference type A was even allowed. This in turn allowed me to further elaborate on the difference between references and objects and what each of them are used for. Finally, I answered that we can either make another function in B that calls on the original function in A by using super keyword, or we can make the function in A and B static, and then define the reference type to be A. Since static functions are not inherited, this would call the class in A. This also allowed me to state what run-time polymorphism is, and how the static keyword works.

Q. What is garbage collection in Java?

-> Basic answer about cleaning up null objects.

Q. What is memory management in Java?

-> I expanded upon what each of heap and stack memory stores.

Q. Which version of Java do you use?

-> I stated that I use Java versions 8 and above, highlighting how version 8 onwards, Java introduced flexibility in interfaces and expanded upon how default and static were allowed, and what their use cases were.

#Tip1: At first glance, the questions seem really basic and straightforward. However, how you decide to answer the question and how in depth you go with the explanation lets the interviewer know about your critical thinking skills, how you analyze a problem and how much of the topic depth you are aware of.

#Tip2: Interview rounds really are a test of your mental strength. Try not to worry too much if your interview is happening late, my interview was last on my panel and only lasted 30 mins compared to other interviews which went for an hour and above. I had mentally given up hope since it had been 7 hours of just sitting and waiting, and some students had started with their round 2 while I hadn't even given my round 1. Such situations might be inevitable, so try not to focus on areas that are out of your control. But try not to let it affect your mindset in the interview, just focus on giving your best performance.

The interviewer then moved on to 2 easy level DSA questions.

Q. Sum of digits of a number, till you reach a single digit.

Eg. $54312 = (5+4+3+1+2) = 15 = (1 + 5) = 6$

Q. Given an array of positive and negative numbers, sort the array into alternating positive and negative elements.

Then we moved on to the projects on my resume, and he asked me questions off of the points I had mentioned in bullets - implementation, why I used a certain thing, etc.

He also asked me if I've worked with cloud deployment, to which I replied honestly with no - but I have deployed my application on render, and explained deployment steps and what CORS is.

I wasn't asked anything regarding SQL, but some other panels did - some things purely depend on your panel and your luck.

#Tip3: Ensure that you really know your projects inside out. It's not necessary to be able to reproduce the code, but you must be aware of the logic and be prepared to justify your design choices. You may ask any LLM to generate relevant questions based on your projects to gain a better understanding of scalability and differing implementation methods.

#Tip4: It's always better to say I don't know over giving a wrong answer.

3. **Techno HR round**[19 candidates appeared]

After 2 hours of anxiously wondering if my name would be called or not, I was called in for the next round. The interview started off with him asking me to introduce myself. I introduced my name, branch, 2 main projects and included a line about the reason I want this job - because I like the satisfaction of debugging something and solving a problem. This led to him starting off with a scenario based problem where he introduced a bug in my project. Thankfully, I had considered all possible edge cases when I was designing my project, so I was able to convince him that my project would not encounter the bug he had explained.

#Tip1: Your introduction really sets the tone for the interview, and allows you to navigate through the topics you want the interviewer to probe you on. I hadn't even planned on including the last line, it was just

something that spontaneously came up in my head and I just said it. I would advise against this - as the interviewer may ask you questions you are unprepared for.

#Tip2: Even if your project is relatively simple, think of making it a complete product. This includes handling edge cases, how your system is designed to scale, and a secure user experience. My main project scope was really simple, but there were enough technical details to discuss with the interviewer because of the extensive tech stack and how I designed the system.

He asked me to design the schema of the project. He then basically gave a scenario where referential integrity of a foreign key was being violated, and asked me if it was possible and why or why not. He then gave a scenario based question based on the project, where a junior disagreed with a certain part of the implementation, and how i would handle it. We then had a discussion on polling vs queuing which was relevant to the logic in my project.

#Tip3: An obvious tip but do keep RISES in mind whenever you're answering any situational questions. Also, prepare scenarios where you demonstrated RISES just in case you're asked about it.

He then asked me if I knew what Binary Search was, its time complexity, and showed me a simple function with a double for loop and asked me for its time complexity ($O(n^2)$).

He then asked me if I was comfortable with python since I had an ML project on my resume. I replied that I wasn't too confident with the language and syntax, as I had mainly used it for its libraries. He then asked what language he could ask questions on, to which I replied with Java.

He then gave me the example:

```
A one = new A("xx", 1)
A two = new A("xx", 1)
```

Q. Can we do `one == two`?

-> We can, but it will be false as it compares two different objects.

Q. How will you check if the values are equal then?

-> By overriding the `.equals()` method.

He also asked me about PostgreSQL vs MySQL, which I was unable to answer.

Lastly, I was asked another situational question where an important presentation is in my laptop, and if I would give my credentials in such a situation to my friend. I answered no as that would be a security risk.

Some people had this round as a purely HR round, others Techno-HR round.

16 candidates were offered the job.

Useful Tips:

Resume tips:

- Apart from just knowing your projects inside out, try to think of edge cases your application might encounter, how you prevent abuse of the system, and how you would scale the system.
- Try to deploy your projects and know about what AWS is and how it works. I was asked about it, but I was unaware.
- Have 2 good projects you can explain, but I was barely asked anything about my third project.
- Be prepared to justify the tech stack used for the project.

Interview tips:

- Learning to face rejections will be an important part of the process. Before Barclays, I faced rejections in my Trilogy interview and my Incred interview. I could not clear OAs for PhonePe, MSCI, EDS, UBS, IDFC.
- 50% of the process depends on your preparation and the other 50% on luck. The panel you get may ask you questions from topics you aren't familiar with, be honest and open to learning. I was lucky that I was asked a lot about my primary language, java.
- Barclays uses Java a lot so it's advantageous if you have projects in springboot or have a strong hold over core Java concepts.

General tips:

- I cannot overstate how big of a factor luck is during placements. I had a streak of bad luck in my OAs before finally getting the offer from Barclays. I only got to start the test in the last 30 mins out of the total 75 minutes in my MSCI OA due to technical issues with my link.
- Don't underestimate the importance of having good projects on your resume, I neglected dev skills and that was the reason I was rejected in my Trilogy interview. Learning from this mistake, I created my main project which I was ultimately asked quite a bit about in my Barclays interview.
- Try to not let the factors that are out of your control affect the factors that you can control.
- You already know the usual, be clear with fundamentals of OOPs, DSA, DBMS, know how to write SQL queries, and be familiar with the technicalities of your mentioned frameworks.

All the best for your placements! It will be very stressful, but it's all part of a learning process.

Feel free to reach out: [LinkedIn](#)